For me, finding these people and putting them to work was really the beginning of the realization of a dream. After years of preaching about what government should be, I had a chance to practice what I preached.

Shortly after the election, a national meeting of governors was scheduled and in a gesture I appreciated, Pat Brown suggested that I represent California instead of him because he would be leaving office soon.

At the conference, I got an idea from Governor Jim Rhodes of Ohio that proved priceless to me, not only in Sacramento but later in Washington. In an effort to streamline his state's government, Governor Rhodes told me he had asked a group of top businessmen in Ohio to evaluate the operations of all state agencies and suggest ways to make them more efficient by applying modern business principles. These advisory panels had come back with hundreds of recommendations, he said.

Since I'd never seen a government agency that was run as efficiently or as economically as a well-run business, I thought it was a great idea and unashamedly borrowed it. I called some of the leading business people in California together at a luncheon, told them what I had in mind, and said, I'll leave it up to you. You tell me how we can make our state government work better."

Within a few days, they had put together an executive board to coordinate the project and a committee to raise money for administrative expenses, and then began studying the operations of every agency in the state government.

Meanwhile, I learned that things were even worse for California than I'd thought they were during the campaign. Through accounting sleight of hand, the previous administration had concealed the fact that the state government was *broke*.